Axon Outpost Site Selection Guide

Why Site Selection Matters

The right site helps Outpost deliver accurate license plate reads, faster installation, and reliable uptime from day one. This guide outlines what to look for when identifying locations that work best.

High-Value Locations to Start With

- These locations typically deliver strong results and smoother deployments:
- City or town entry and exit points
- Highway on-ramps and off-ramps
- Jurisdictional boundaries
- Agency-identified crime areas

Roadway Basics

Ideal conditions

- Straight sections of roadway
- Predictable traffic flow
- Clearly marked lanes
- One to two lanes per direction

May require additional review

- Sharp curves
- Complex intersections
- Areas with frequent stopping or parking
- Poorly marked or irregular lanes

New Pole Installation: What to Look For

Good candidates

- Near the roadway but well outside the travel lane risk of collision
- Behind curbs or guardrails
- Clear, unobstructed views of traffic
- Enough space to install without blocking sidewalks

Locations That May Require Additional Review or an Alternate Site

- Narrow sidewalks
- Directly in front of driveways or entrances
- Heavily landscaped areas or tight medians with limited access

Mounting on Existing Poles: What to Look For

Good candidates

- Clear unobstructed views of target traffic lanes
- Clear Mounting Surface: an unobstructed area on pole where camera hardware can be posited between (12-16ft) with banding clamps (round poles preferred)
- Round poles that allow hardware to be attached using banding clamps
- Sufficient space to perform the installation without blocking the roadway or requiring traffic control

Locations That May Require Additional Review or an Alternate Site

- Poles with significant existing equipment already mounted
- Mounting or electrical restrictions due to pole ownership
- Irregular pole shapes
- Heavily landscaped areas or tight medians with limited access

Considerations to record when choosing Existing Poles

- Specify pole type and material: traffic, utility, decorative, wood, steel, etc.
- AC power check: visually verify whether the pole has an existing AC power source, junction box, and or disconnect available
- Determine whether AC or solar power will be used on the existing pole. Both are feasible with proper permission from the pole owner

Power Considerations

Existing power works best when

- Streetlight or utility poles are available
- There is visible power infrastructure
- The location has limited sunlight at times throughout the year (take winter into consideration)

Solar works best when

- The site has open sky exposure
- There is minimal shading from trees or buildings
- The location has good year-round sun access (take winter into consideration)

Visibility & Performance Tips

- The camera should have a clear line of sight to vehicle plates
- Max distance 75ft to target for outpost, max 120ft to target for lightpost
- Avoid placing cameras where reflective road signs are in direct camera field of view
- Choose locations with minimal visual clutter in field of view

Ownership & Permitting

Knowing who controls the site early helps avoid delays. If ownership is unclear, no problem, just make a note of it.

- Pole ownership
- City-owned sites often move fastest
- State- or DOT-controlled roads will require additional approvals
- Private property requires owner permission

What to Share with Your Axon Team

When submitting sites, please include the following information. You should receive a template to complete this; if you have not, please let your Axon Outpost or Lightpost representative know and one will be provided.

- Address or GPS (Latitude, Longitude) pin
- Notes on existing pole and power supply (if known)
- Road name and traffic direction of target lanes
- Confirmation that the agency supports the location
- Photos of the site, if available

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